Project 3-1: Analyze File and Url for File-Based Viruses Using VirusTotal part 1

Objective: Given a scenario, analyze potential indicators to determine the type of attack.

Description: VirusTotal is a free online service that analyzes files and urls to identify potential malware. VirusTotal combines 70 antivirus scanners and url/domain blacklisting services along with other tools to identify malware. A wide range of files can be submitted to VirusTotal for examination, such as user data files and documents, executable programs, pdFs, and images. One of the uses of VirusTotal is to provide a "second opinion" on a file or url that may have been flagged as suspicious by other scanning software. In this project, you use VirusTotal to scan a file and a url

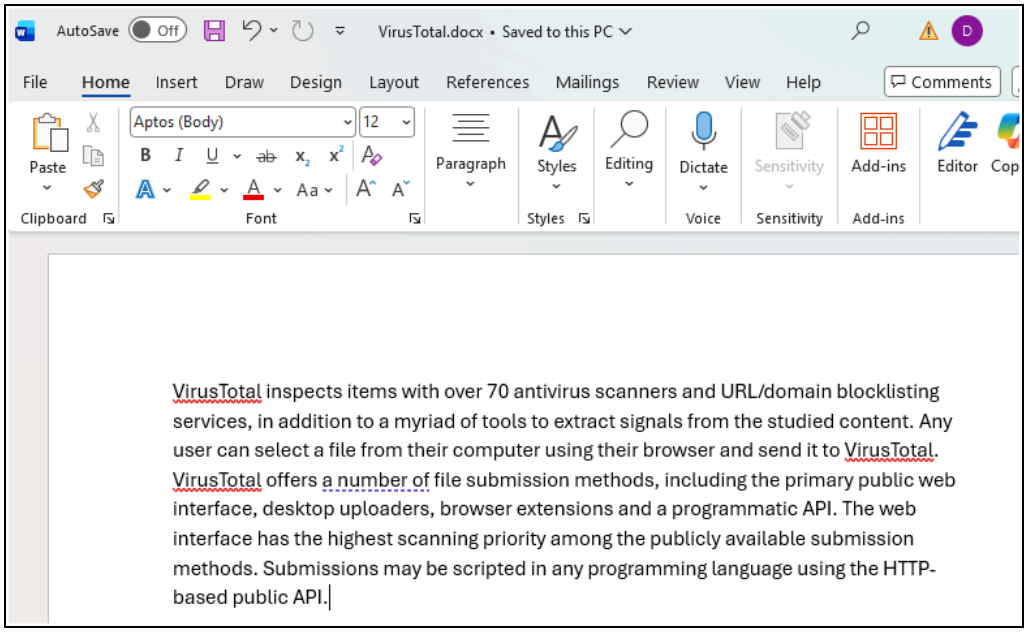
1. First view several viruses from 20 years ago and observe their benign but annoying impact. Open your web browser and enter the url **archive.org/details/malwaremuseum&tab=collection** (if you are no longer able to access the site through the web address, use a search engine to search for "Malware Museum").

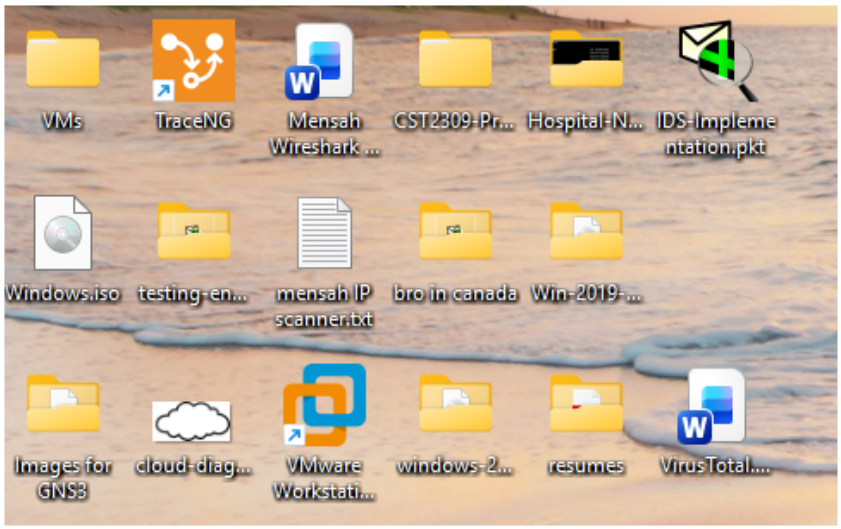
2. All of the viruses have been rendered ineffective and will not harm a computer. click several of the viruses and notice what they do.

3. When finished, close your web browser.

4. Use Microsoft Word to create a document that contains the preceding paragraph description about VirusTotal. Save the document as **VirusTotal.docx.**

Note i saved it in my desktop





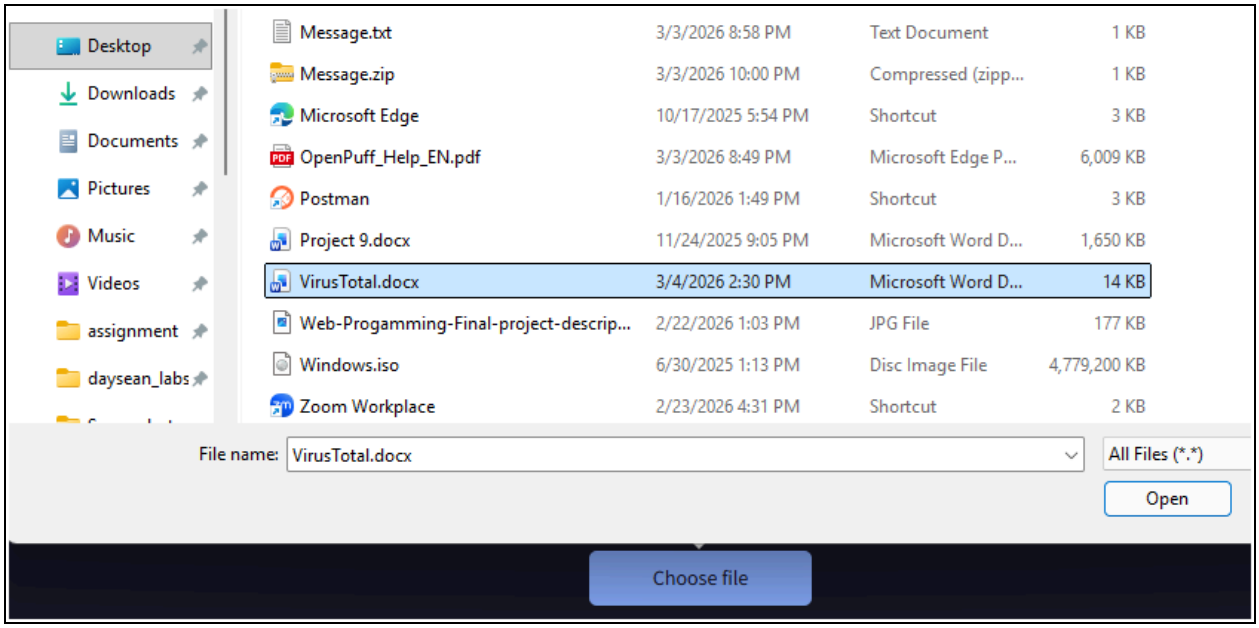
5. Exit Word.

6. Open your web browser and enter the url https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/upload (if you are no longer able to access the site through the web address, use a search engine to search for "Virus Total").

7. If necessary, click the **File** tab.

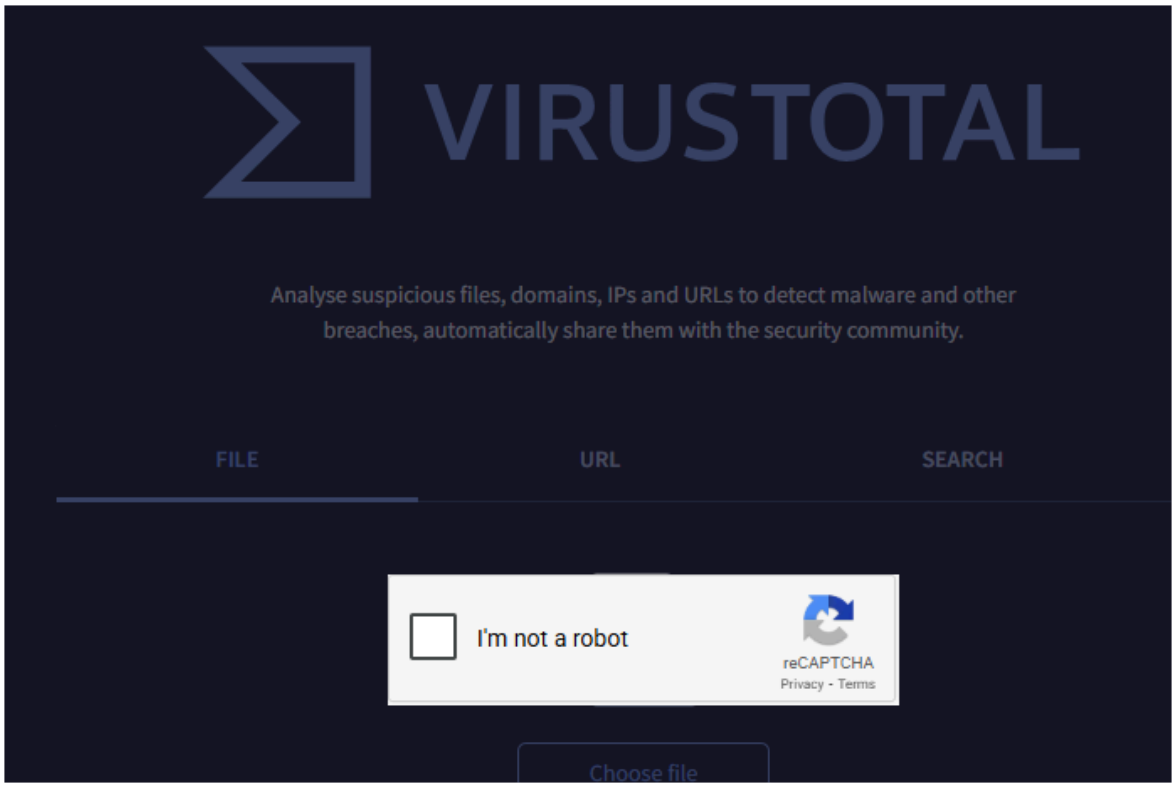
8. Click **Choose File**.

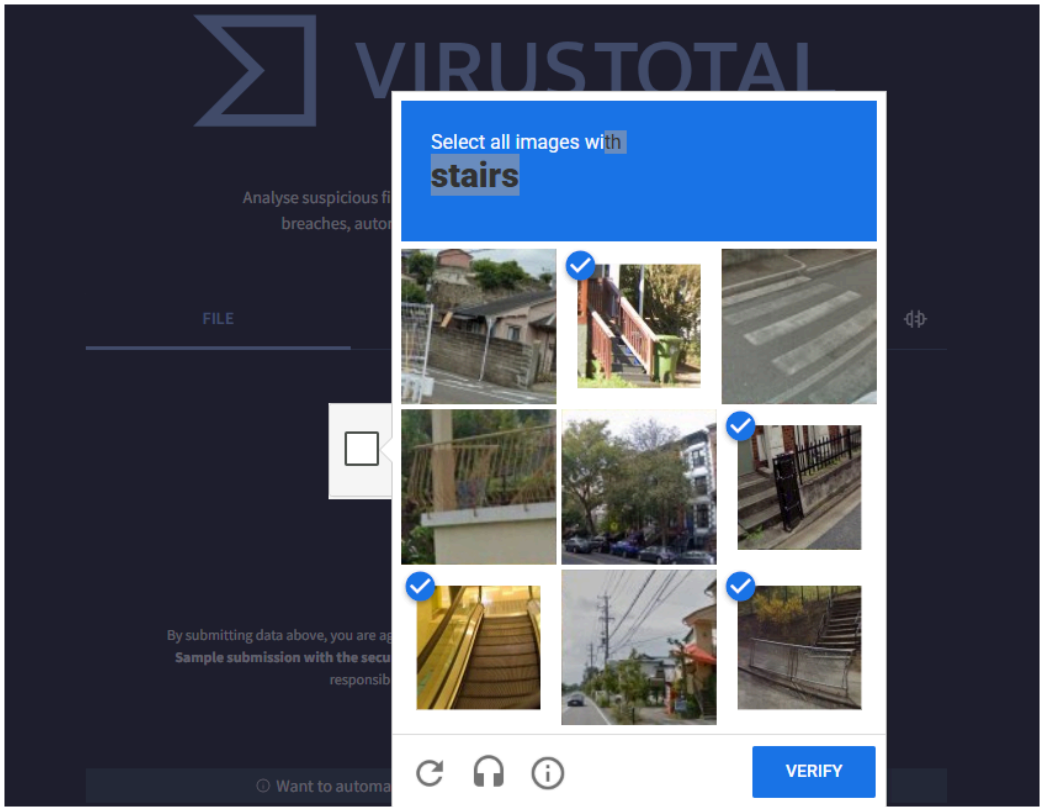
9. Navigate to the location of **VirusTotal.docx** and click **Open**.



10. Click **Confirm upload**.

Do the capture

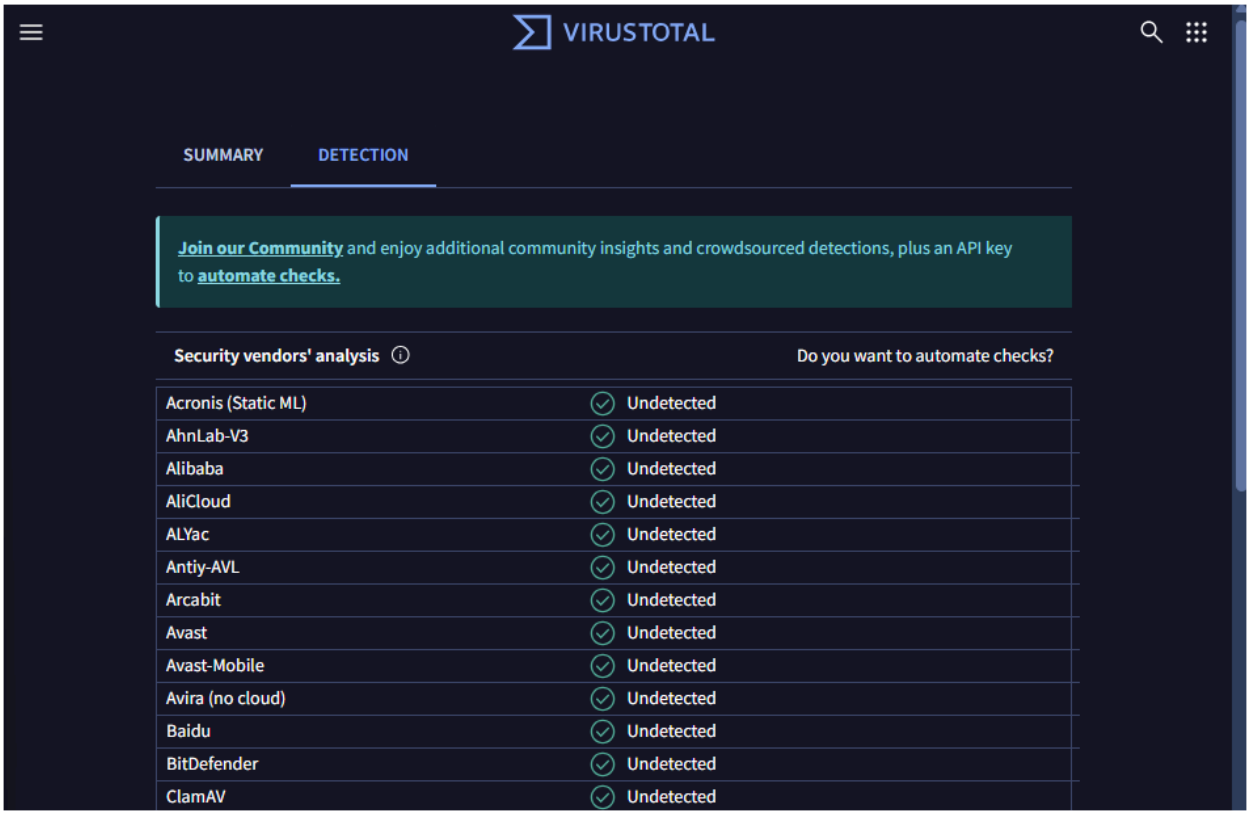




Note I had to rede Do 7-10 again

11. Wait until the upload and analysis are completed.

12. Scroll through the list of antivirus (AV) vendors that have been polled regarding this file. A green checkmark means no malware was detected.



Note theres more but im showing all

13. Click the **DETAILS** tab and read through the analysis.

SUMMARY | DETECTION | DETAILS | RELATIONS | BEHAVIOR | COMMUNITY

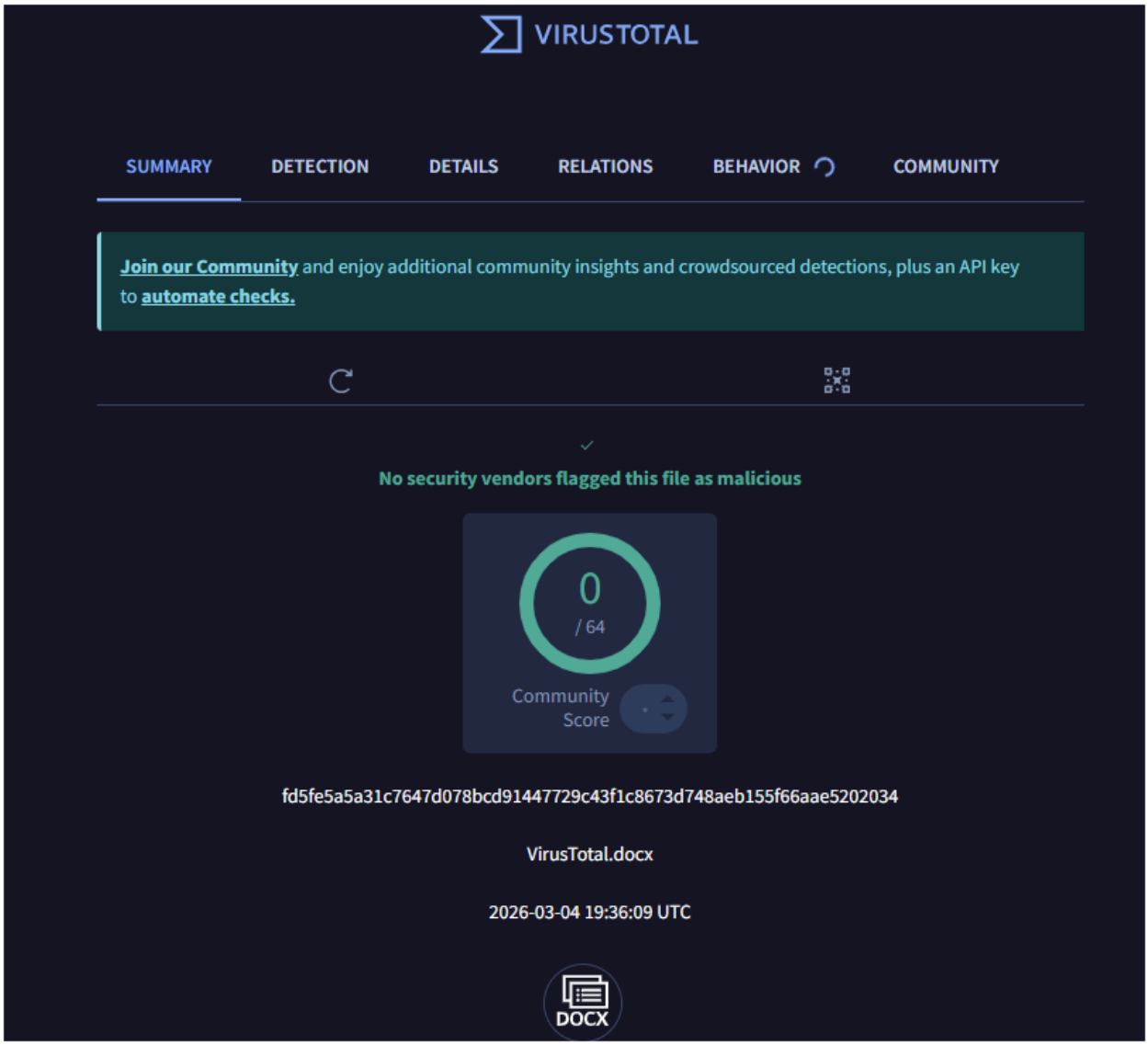
Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to **automate checks.**

Basic properties

MD5	5e8f6f795fc9c616409992f2e4d04571
SHA-1	ac3269ee35cd9d9f25520dc7e93e3e6b1846b457
SHA-256	fd5fe5a5a31c7647d078bcd91447729c43f1c8673d748aeb155f66aae5202034
Vhash	c48e35d5862a41938979201cd4a4c036
SSDEEP	192:Ct1hHtp6CQmeLiVyTo8P/Rc+UyhhnQk+UjKjOHYO0Kzi1ywlR+CRtGM4DdV2Q:a1xtp6X...
TLSH	T1BE52AE89C246B512E89788BD8020A1EBF32944D3621D9A3B1177B31DE322C87675FBDD
File type	Office Open XML Document document msoffice text word docx
Magic	Microsoft Word 2007+
TrID	Word Microsoft Office Open XML Format document (52.2%) | Open Packaging Conventio...
File size	13.42 KB (13744 bytes)

History

Creation Time	2026-03-04 19:30:00 UTC
First Submission	2026-03-04 19:36:09 UTC
Last Submission	2026-03-04 19:36:09 UTC
Last Analysis	2026-03-04 19:36:09 UTC



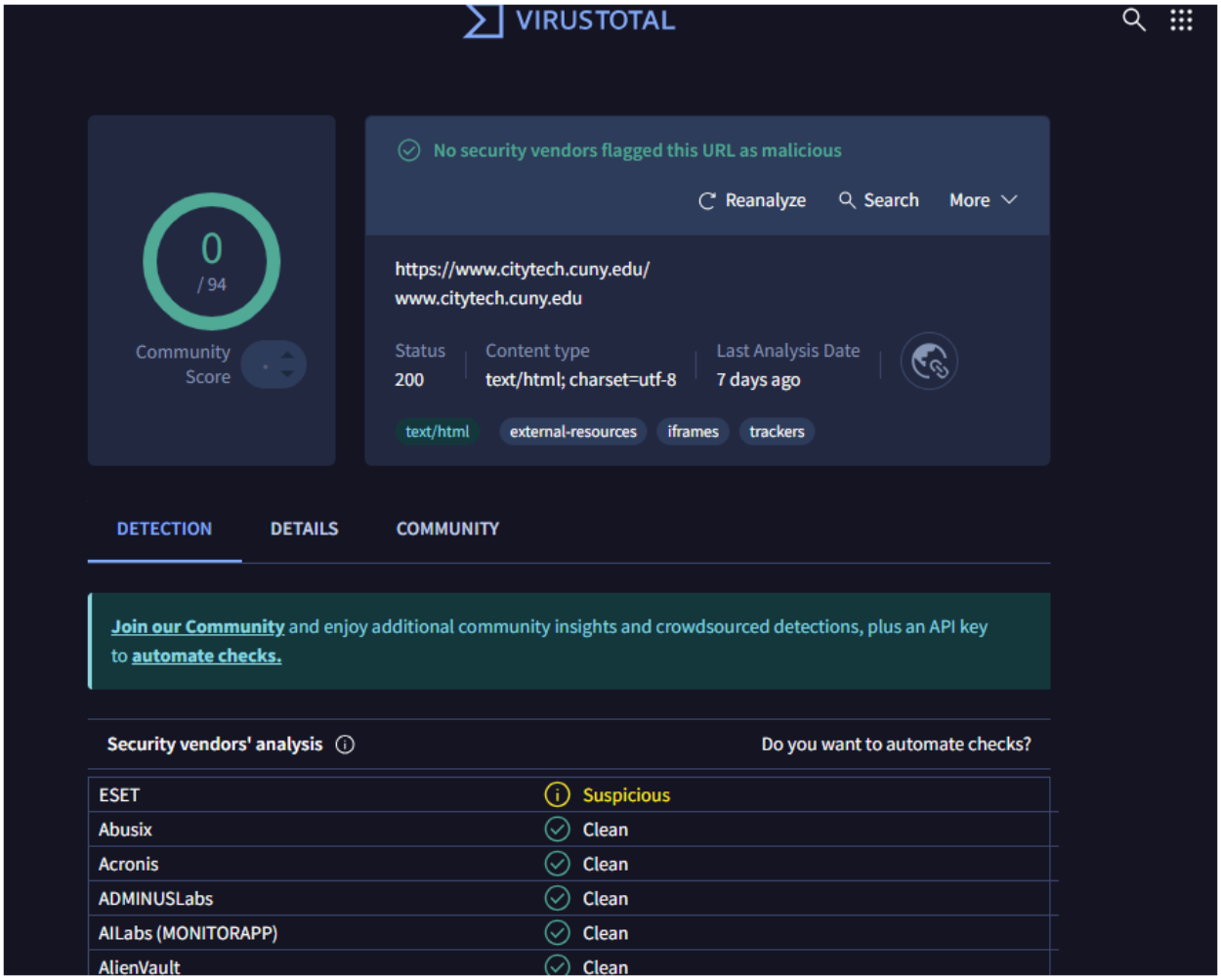
14. Use your browser's back button to return to the VirusTotal home page.

15. Now you will analyze a website. click **url**.

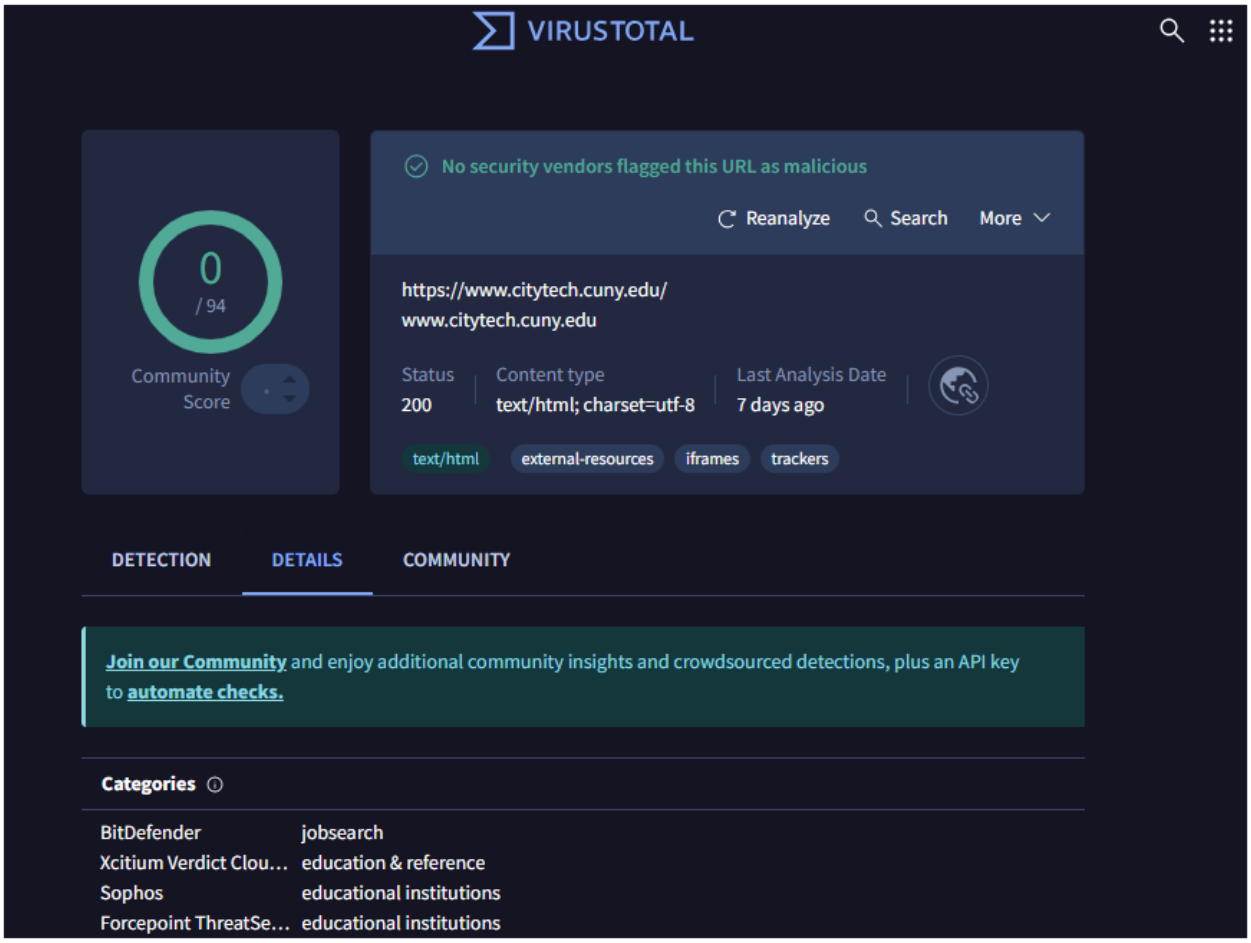
16. Enter the url of your school, place of employment, or another site with which you are familiar.

Click Search

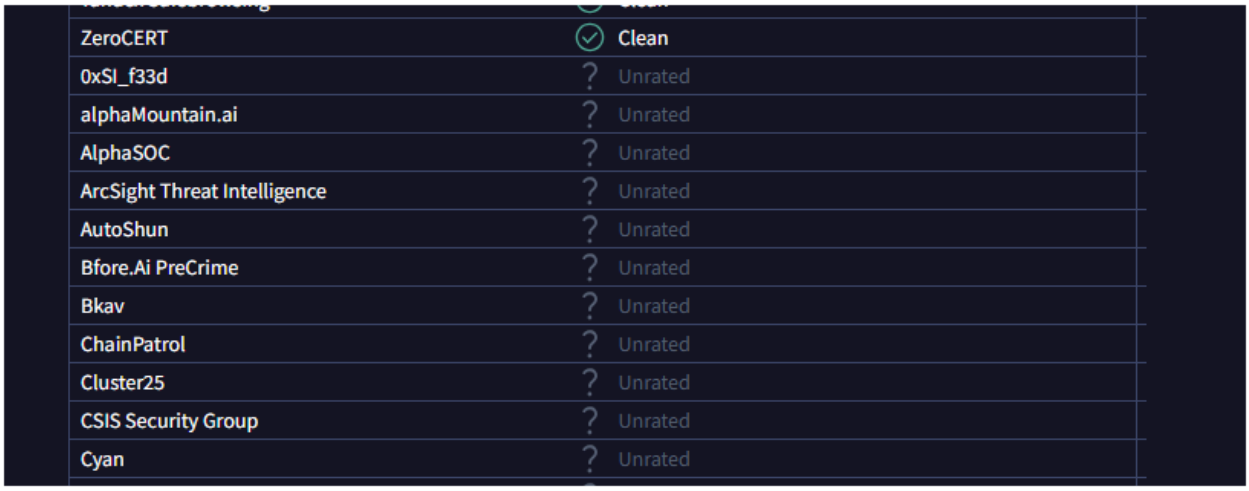
17. Wait until the analysis is completed.



18. click the **DETAILs** tab and read through the analysis.



19.Scroll through the list of vendor analysis. Do any of these sites indicate an **unrated site** or **Malware site**? Yes about 30% of the were Unrated



20. How could VirusTotal be useful to users? How could it be useful to security researchers? Could it also be used by attackers to test their own malware before distributing it to ensure that it does not trigger an AV alert? What should be the protections against this?

Virus can be useful for users because it can give them useful information about a file or a website such as if the file is clean or suspicious.

Security research can use Virus total to scan for malware or viruses.

Yes, attackers can use it to test their own malware before distributing it to see if it bypasses detection. A protection for that will be to use other Anti Virus/Malware tools. Security researchers or the Cyber Security teams can test unsafe files using an isolated sandbox.